UPSC Weekly Current Affairs

9 – 15 November 2026 · 5 top stories · 30 also important · Sources: PIB and The Hindu

Subject	Stories	Headline to know
International Relations	8	Trump says likely to meet Putin, Xi at China APEC summit
Governance & Social Justice	8	ED attaches properties in Kashmir in ‘misuse’ of PM Employment Generation Programme scheme
Geography	5	Trump to meet Iran war mediator Qatar, no imminent deal seen to end war
Polity & Constitution	4	Postpone panchayat, municipal elections to April-May next year: Ladakh group
Environment & Ecology	3	Heat-trapping carbon pollution drops, but scientists cite Iran war rather than energy prog
Reports & Indices	2	Keralam measles outbreaks call for a relook at disease epidemiology
History & Art and Culture	2	Cyclone Murasu: Heavy rain and power cuts dampen spirit of Deepavali
Agriculture	1	Island fisheries at the centre of India’s Blue Economy push
Science & Technology	1	How AI is reshaping China’s universities
Disaster Management	1	APSDRF rescues eight, evacuates 341 during Cyclone Arnab relief efforts

Top stories of the week

Trump says likely to meet Putin, Xi at China APEC summit

Tue 10 Nov · International Relations · GS2

• President Donald Trump indicated to reporters that a deal on the Russia-Ukraine war, the Iran issue and nuclear arms control would be on the agenda

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Internal security:** Unsettled LAC (eastern Ladakh, Arunachal): border infrastructure, disengagement and buffer zones; China's dual-use villages (Xiaokang) and dams on the Brahmaputra (Yarlung Tsangpo).
• **Economy:** Large trade deficit and dependence on Chinese inputs (APIs, electronics, solar, rare earths) drive PLI schemes, Press Note 3 (2020) FDI curbs and supply-chain diversification.
• **International relations:** Strategic competition in the Indian Ocean (String of Pearls), BRI vs connectivity alternatives (IMEC), and balancing via Quad while engaging in BRICS/SCO.

Static connect: APEC

• Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation, formed in 1989; 21 member economies around the Pacific Rim.
• India is not a member.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Trump, Putin, China APEC, President Donald Trump, Russia-Ukraine

Source: The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/international/us-china-russia-leaders-to-meet-next-week-says

Island fisheries at the centre of India’s Blue Economy push

Tue 10 Nov · Agriculture · GS3

• India is endowed with a vast and diverse marine resource base, supported by a coastline of approximately 11,099 km and an Exclusive Economic Zone of nearly 24 lakh sq.
• With an estimated marine fisheries potential of 58.6 lakh MT within its EEZ, the sector plays a vital role in sustaining the livelihoods of nearly 50 lakh fishers, while contributing significantly to food security, nutrition, employment, income…

Static connect: Blue Economy

• India's coastline is about 11,099 km (revised measurement) and its Exclusive Economic Zone about 2 million sq km.
• Schemes include PM Matsya Sampada Yojana and the Deep Ocean Mission.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Island, Blue Economy, Exclusive Economic Zone, EEZ

Source: PIB, Ministry of Fisheries, Animal Husbandry & Dairying, 10 Nov 2026 · https://pib.gov.in/PressReleasePage.aspx?PRID=2334511

ED attaches properties in Kashmir in ‘misuse’ of PM Employment Generation Programme scheme case

Tue 10 Nov · Governance & Social Justice, Economy · GS2, GS3

• An ED spokesman said there was misappropriation of PMEGP Scheme’s loans in criminal conspiracy with the PMEGP borrowers, bank officials of Sumbal Branch and Gamud Gadkhud Branch of J&K Bank and other unknown persons

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Internal security:** Infiltration, hybrid terrorists and narco-terror links; normalcy indicators such as tourism and voter turnout.
• **Governance & polity:** After the abrogation of Article 370 (2019, upheld by the Supreme Court in 2023), questions of statehood restoration and Sixth Schedule demands in Ladakh.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Kashmir, PM Employment Generation Programme, PMEGP Scheme, PMEGP, Sumbal Branch and Gamud Gadkhud Branch

Source: The Hindu, National, 09 Nov 2026 ·
https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/jammu-and-kashmir/ed-attaches-properties-in-kashmir

Cyber bullying affects one in ten students worldwide; AI fuels new threat: UNESCO

Tue 10 Nov · International Relations, Science & Technology · GS1, GS2, GS3

• The United Nations agency has called upon countries to invest in digital safety measures, teacher preparation, and mental health support for students, in coordination with technology companies

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Internal security:** Cyber attacks on critical infrastructure and fraud like 'digital arrest' scams; CERT-In, NCIIPC and I4C are the response agencies.
• **Governance & polity:** IT Act 2000, Digital Personal Data Protection Act 2023, and the need for cyber hygiene and capacity in state police.
• **Science & tech:** IndiaAI Mission (2024) for compute, datasets and indigenous models; India hosted the AI Impact Summit in 2026.
• **Ethics:** Deepfakes, bias, privacy and accountability call for responsible-AI rules and platform obligations under the IT Rules.

Static connect: UNESCO lists

• World Heritage under the 1972 Convention; Intangible Cultural Heritage under the 2003 Convention.
• UNESCO also runs the Man and the Biosphere (MAB) programme and Global Geoparks.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Cyber, UNESCO, United Nations

Source: The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/sci-tech/health/cyber-bullying-affects-one-in-ten-students-worldw

Supreme Court terms vehicular emissions major contributor to air pollution in Delhi-NCR

Tue 10 Nov · Governance & Social Justice, Environment & Ecology · GS2, GS3

• The Bench highlighted the large number of vehicles plying on roads connecting Delhi with neighbouring areas, including Ghaziabad, Greater Noida, Gurugram and Faridabad

Why it matters for India and UPSC

• **Governance & polity:** Judicial review and the separation of powers; such rulings often clarify fundamental rights or federal relations and become Mains examples.
• **Society:** Access to justice and pendency (over 5 crore cases) affect citizens' trust in institutions.
• **Environment:** India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.
• **International relations:** India speaks for the Global South on climate finance and technology transfer; carbon border taxes like the EU's CBAM affect Indian exports.

Static connect: Air quality governance

• Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR (statutory since 2021) enforces the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP).
• National Clean Air Programme (NCAP, 2019) targets particulate reduction in non-attainment cities.

Prelims pointers

• Key terms: Supreme Court, Delhi-NCR, Bench, Delhi, Ghaziabad

Source: The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026 · https://www.thehindu.com/news/national/supreme-court-terms-vehicular-emissions-major-contr

Also important this week

DISASTER MANAGEMENT

• **APSDRF rescues eight, evacuates 341 during Cyclone Arnab relief efforts** (The Hindu, National, 09 Nov 2026)
APSDRF rescues eight, evacuates 341 during Cyclone Arnab relief efforts
Why it matters **Geography & disasters**: India is exposed to cyclones, floods and heatwaves; the Disaster Management Act, 2005 (amended 2025), NDMA and NDRF/SDRF lead the response.; **Governance & polity**: Shift from relief to risk reduction (Sendai Framework); early warning, CDRI and climate-resilient infrastructure.

ENVIRONMENT & ECOLOGY

• **Heat-trapping carbon pollution drops, but scientists cite Iran war rather than energy progress** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)
In 2026, the world emitted 42.2 billion tonne of heat-trapping carbon dioxide from the burning of fossil fuels such as coal, oil and gas.
Why it matters **Economy**: India imports most of its crude oil, much of it from the Gulf; conflict raises oil prices, shipping and insurance costs, inflation and the current account defic; **Society**: About 9 million Indians live in the Gulf; their safety (evacuation operations such as Ajay/Kaveri) and remittances (India is the world's largest recipient) are

• **A case for Nepal: suing major carbon emitters for floods** (The Hindu, Environment, 09 Nov 2026)
While climate wrongs harm society, they do not harm individuals in a sufficiently direct and proximate way
Why it matters **International relations**: Open border under the 1950 Treaty of Peace and Friendship; map dispute over Kalapani–Lipulekh–Limpiyadhura; competition with Chinese investment.; **Internal security**: Open border can be misused for trafficking, fake currency and movement of criminals; SSB guards it.

• **COP31 opens as climate and geopolitical pressures mount** (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)
More than 100,000 people are expected to attend COP31 in a sprawling expo centre in the Mediterranean seaside city of Antalya over the next two weeks
Why it matters **Environment**: India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.; **International relations**: India speaks for the Global South on climate finance and technology transfer; carbon border taxes like the EU's CBAM affect Indian exports.

GEOGRAPHY

• **Trump to meet Iran war mediator Qatar, no imminent deal seen to end war** (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)
Mutual attacks continue, with the U.S.

Why it matters **Economy**: US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.; **International relations**: Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BR

• **Strait of Hormuz LNG traffic hits highest in October since Iran war began** (The Hindu, Economy, 10 Nov 2026)
October exports ■were ■the highest since February when the war ■started and were up from September's corresponding tally of 23 vessels exiting the strait

Why it matters **Economy**: India imports most of its crude oil, much of it from the Gulf; conflict raises oil prices, shipping and insurance costs, inflation and the current account defic; **Society**: About 9 million Indians live in the Gulf; their safety (evacuation operations such as Ajay/Kaveri) and remittances (India is the world's largest recipient) are

• **Oil falls as Donald Trump says new Iran attacks 'unlikely'** (The Hindu, Economy, 09 Nov 2026)
On November 8, 2026, ■Iraq reached an understanding with the U.S.

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• **Trump says resumption of war with Iran 'highly unlikely'** (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)
Iran continues to at least partly block traffic through the strategic Strait of Hormuz, which has dented oil supplies out of the Gulf.

Why it matters **Economy**: US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.; **International relations**: Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BR

• **Who is Stephen Miller, Trump's new Chief of Staff?** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)
Stephen Miller, one of U.S.

Why it matters **Economy**: US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.; **International relations**: Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BR

GOVERNANCE & SOCIAL JUSTICE

• **NMC cautions students against fake medical colleges, asks them to verify approvals** (The Hindu, National, 10 Nov 2026)
The advisory follows the Supreme Court taking cognisance of the issue in an ongoing case in which the court directed regulatory bodies, including the National Medical Commission, to caution students and parents against dealing with unauthorised educational ins

Why it matters **Governance & polity**: Judicial review and the separation of powers; such rulings often clarify fundamental rights or federal relations and become Mains examples.; **Society**: Access to justice and pendency (over 5 crore cases) affect citizens' trust in institutions.

• **Deepavali pollution spike: How does it affect lung function and respiratory health? | Explained** (The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026)
Firecracker smoke releases fine particles and harmful gases that irritate the airways and affect lung health.

Why it matters **Environment**: Air pollution is a public-health emergency in North India; NCAP, GRAP and the Commission for Air Quality Management (2021) are the policy tools.; **Governance & polity**: Needs inter-state coordination (Punjab, Haryana, Delhi) and alternatives to stubble burning such as Happy Seeder and bio-decomposers.

• **China says 2026 trade surplus surpassed $1 trillion in October** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)
Exports from the world's second-largest economy have surged in recent months, driven in part by soaring global demand for artificial intelligence-related products including computer chips, data centre servers and networking equipment

Why it matters **Internal security**: Unsettled LAC (eastern Ladakh, Arunachal): border infrastructure, disengagement and buffer zones; China's dual-use villages (Xiaokang) and dams on the Brahmaput; **Economy**: Large trade deficit and dependence on Chinese inputs (APIs, electronics, solar, rare earths) drive PLI schemes, Press Note 3 (2020) FDI curbs and supply-chain d

• **Trump says FBI looking into Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang's affair with 'Chinese agent'** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)

The sudden emergence of Nvidia CEO Huang's infidelity has created concerns about whether China has been able to access the cutting-edge chips designed by Nvidia that are powering the development of artificial intelligence

Why it matters **Economy**: US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.; **International relations**: Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BR

• **Air pollution over 66 times WHO limit in parts of Delhi as people defy ban on firecrackers on Deepavali** (The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026)

Data on air pollution missing from several monitoring stations of the Delhi Government at the peak of air pollution during the intervening night of November 8 and 9

Why it matters **Environment**: Air pollution is a public-health emergency in North India; NCAP, GRAP and the Commission for Air Quality Management (2021) are the policy tools.; **Governance & polity**: Needs inter-state coordination (Punjab, Haryana, Delhi) and alternatives to stubble burning such as Happy Seeder and bio-decomposers.

• **What to know about upcoming peace talks involving Russian, Ukrainian and U.S. officials** (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)

The upcoming Abu Dhabi talks focus on security guarantees amid stalled peace efforts and ongoing fighting

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HISTORY & ART AND CULTURE

• **Cyclone Murasu: Heavy rain and power cuts dampen spirit of Deepavali** (The Hindu, National, 10 Nov 2026)

Heavy downpour and power cuts have dampened the festival spirit among everyone, right from kids to elderly people and farmers to retail vendors

Why it matters **Geography & disasters**: India is exposed to cyclones, floods and heatwaves; the Disaster Management Act, 2005 (amended 2025), NDMA and NDRF/SDRF lead the response.; **Governance & polity**: Shift from relief to risk reduction (Sendai Framework); early warning, CDRI and climate-resilient infrastructure.

• **Fisherfolk seek higher compensation for men who died in Murasu cyclone** (The Hindu, National, 09 Nov 2026)

Neithal Makkal Katchi's K.

Why it matters **Geography & disasters**: India is exposed to cyclones, floods and heatwaves; the Disaster Management Act, 2005 (amended 2025), NDMA and NDRF/SDRF lead the response.; **Governance & polity**: Shift from relief to risk reduction (Sendai Framework); early warning, CDRI and climate-resilient infrastructure.

INTERNATIONAL RELATIONS

• **G7 Ministers meet on efforts to end Ukraine conflict, halt new Iran war** (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)

Ministers from the leading industrialised nations of Britain, Canada, France, Germany, Italy, Japan and the United States will be gathering with preoccupations strikingly similar to those of the last such meeting in March

Why it matters **International relations**: India's strategic autonomy: abstentions at the UN, call for dialogue and diplomacy, while keeping ties with Russia and the West.; **Economy**: Discounted Russian crude, fertiliser and defence spares; Western sanctions and secondary tariffs create payment and trade risks for India.

• **Tens of thousands march in Amsterdam, pressing Dutch government on Gaza, Israel** (The Hindu, International, 08 Nov 2026)

Organisers of the "Red Line" demonstration called for stricter trade sanctions, a halt to arms sales, and an official declaration that Israel's actions in Gaza amount to genocide

Why it matters **Economy**: India imports most of its crude oil, much of it from the Gulf; conflict raises oil prices, shipping and insurance costs, inflation and the current account defic; **Society**: About 9 million Indians live in the Gulf; their safety (evacuation operations such as Ajay/Kaveri) and remittances (India is the world's largest recipient) are

• **Past talks involving Russia and Ukraine have yielded little progress toward peace** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)

Key developments from past sessions since Moscow's full-scale invasion of its neighbor on Feb.

Why it matters **International relations**: India's strategic autonomy: abstentions at the UN, call for dialogue and diplomacy, while keeping ties with Russia and the West.; **Economy**: Discounted Russian crude, fertiliser and defence spares; Western sanctions and secondary tariffs create payment and trade risks for India.

• **Republican Thomas Massie of Kentucky launches bid to impeach Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)

Thomas Massie, who was defeated by a Trump-backed challenger in a primary earlier this year, said Pete Hegseth's actions amounted to high crimes and misdemeanors

Why it matters **Economy**: US is India's largest export market; tariffs, H-1B visa rules and trade-deal talks hit IT services, textiles, gems and pharma exports and the rupee.; **International relations**: Comprehensive Global Strategic Partnership: defence deals, iCET/TRUST technology cooperation, Quad; India balances this with strategic autonomy (Russian oil, BR

• **Russia hits power stations in Ukraine, vessel in Black Sea** (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)

Russia’s armed forces struck three Ukrainian power substations overnight.

Why it matters **International relations**: India's strategic autonomy: abstentions at the UN, call for dialogue and diplomacy, while keeping ties with Russia and the West.; **Economy**: Discounted Russian crude, fertiliser and defence spares; Western sanctions and secondary tariffs create payment and trade risks for India.

• **Kremlin hopes U.S. election shake-up won't shift Trump's negotiations on Ukraine** (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)

Peskov shrugged off a question from reporters on whether the new Congress would challenge Mr.

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POLITY & CONSTITUTION

• **Postpone panchayat, municipal elections to April-May next year: Ladakh group** (The Hindu, National, 09 Nov 2026)

“We suspect that this government is up to some mischief.

Why it matters **Internal security**: Infiltration, hybrid terrorists and narco-terror links; normalcy indicators such as tourism and voter turnout.; **Governance & polity**: After the abrogation of Article 370 (2019, upheld by the Supreme Court in 2023), questions of statehood restoration and Sixth Schedule demands in Ladakh.

• **Commercial cultivation within forest land not protected under FRA, 2006: Supreme Court** (The Hindu, Environment, 09 Nov 2026)

Says FRA protects forest-dwelling communities dependent on forests for generations, not commercial cultivators and plantation owners

Why it matters **Governance & polity**: Judicial review and the separation of powers; such rulings often clarify fundamental rights or federal relations and become Mains examples.; **Society**: Access to justice and pendency (over 5 crore cases) affect citizens' trust in institutions.

• **Health officials step up surveillance as Shigella cases rise in Kerala’s Malappuram** (The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026)

Five of the eight Shigella cases reported in Malappuram district are linked to a wedding feast at Korakkuthu in Elamkulam panchayat near Perinthalmanna

Why it matters **Economy**: RBI's MPC targets 4% CPI inflation (±2%); rate decisions affect EMIs, credit growth, investment and the rupee.; **Society**: Food inflation hits poor households the most; links to supply-side measures like buffer stocks and export curbs.

• **Eisenkot warns of Israel crisis as he seeks to replace Netanyahu’s government** (The Hindu, International, 08 Nov 2026)

isenkot, 66, a political novice who has vowed to bridge Israel's deep polarisation under Netanyahu, formally received a mandate from President Isaac Herzog, giving him 28 days to form a government despite his bloc lacking a clear majority

Why it matters **Economy**: India imports most of its crude oil, much of it from the Gulf; conflict raises oil prices, shipping and insurance costs, inflation and the current account defic; **Society**: About 9 million Indians live in the Gulf; their safety (evacuation operations such as Ajay/Kaveri) and remittances (India is the world's largest recipient) are

REPORTS & INDICES

• **Keralam measles outbreaks call for a relook at disease epidemiology** (The Hindu, Health, 09 Nov 2026)

Once predominantly a childhood disease affecting children aged one to five, measles is now being reported across age groups, including among fully vaccinated individuals and infants below nine months, who are not yet eligible for routine measles vaccination

Why it matters **Society**: Public health outcomes and out-of-pocket spending; schemes like Ayushman Bharat PM-JAY and the TB-elimination target.; **Governance & polity**: Health is a State subject; centre–state coordination and the One Health approach for disease surveillance.

• **World entering ‘age of climate extremes’: UN chief** (The Hindu, International, 09 Nov 2026)
The UN chief statement came as the UN’s World Meteorological Organization released a report indicating that 2026 has continued a streak of exceptional global temperatures, melting ice and rising sea levels
Why it matters **Environment**: India's NDCs (45% cut in emission intensity of GDP from 2005 levels by 2030, 50% non-fossil power capacity, net zero by 2070) and the principle of CBDR-RC.; **International relations**: India speaks for the Global South on climate finance and technology transfer; carbon border taxes like the EU's CBAM affect Indian exports.

SCIENCE & TECHNOLOGY

• **How AI is reshaping China’s universities** (The Hindu, International, 10 Nov 2026)
AI disruption and a tightening job market are driving a sweeping change across China’s universities; under the government’s ‘guideline on the reform of higher education institutions’, universities will now be tasked with specific goals, pursuing either researc
Why it matters **Internal security**: Unsettled LAC (eastern Ladakh, Arunachal): border infrastructure, disengagement and buffer zones; China's dual-use villages (Xiaokang) and dams on the Brahmaput; **Economy**: Large trade deficit and dependence on Chinese inputs (APIs, electronics, solar, rare earths) drive PLI schemes, Press Note 3 (2020) FDI curbs and supply-chain d

Prelims quick revision

• In entire India 13 crore voters were dropped from the voter list.
• Ladakh is a small region and fraud is easy,” said Ladakh Buddhist Association (LBA) chairman Tsering Dorjey Lakrook

Static topics that came up this week

APEC
• Asia-Pacific Economic Cooperation, formed in 1989; 21 member economies around the Pacific Rim.
• India is not a member.

Blue Economy
• India's coastline is about 11,099 km (revised measurement) and its Exclusive Economic Zone about 2 million sq km.
• Schemes include PM Matsya Sampada Yojana and the Deep Ocean Mission.

UNESCO lists
• World Heritage under the 1972 Convention; Intangible Cultural Heritage under the 2003 Convention.
• UNESCO also runs the Man and the Biosphere (MAB) programme and Global Geoparks.

Air quality governance
• Commission for Air Quality Management in NCR (statutory since 2021) enforces the Graded Response Action Plan (GRAP).
• National Clean Air Programme (NCAP, 2019) targets particulate reduction in non-attainment cities.

Qeshm Island (Iran)
• Largest island in the Persian Gulf, in Iran's Hormozgan province, across from the port of Bandar Abbas.
• Lies at the Strait of Hormuz; nearby islands: Hormuz, Larak, Kish; Abu Musa and the Greater/Lesser Tunbs are disputed between Iran and the UAE.
• Known for the Hara mangrove forests and a free trade zone.

Strait of Hormuz
• Connects the Persian Gulf with the Gulf of Oman and the Arabian Sea.
• Lies between Iran (north) and Oman's Musandam peninsula (south).
• Major chokepoint for crude oil and LNG exports from the Gulf, including a large part of India's energy imports.

G7
• US, UK, France, Germany, Italy, Japan and Canada, with the EU taking part; India is often invited as an outreach partner.

Gaza Strip
• Narrow Palestinian territory on the Mediterranean coast, bordering Israel and Egypt (Rafah crossing).
• India's long-standing position supports a two-state solution.

UNFCCC & Paris Agreement
• UNFCCC adopted at the 1992 Rio Earth Summit; the Conference of Parties (COP) meets yearly.
• Paris Agreement (COP21, 2015): keep warming well below 2°C, pursue 1.5°C; countries submit NDCs.
• India's targets include net zero by 2070.

Black Sea and the Turkish Straits

- The Bosporus and Dardanelles (Türkiye) link the Black Sea to the Mediterranean via the Sea of Marmara.
- Passage of warships is governed by the Montreux Convention (1936).